

7.5 Final Budget Reconciliation

The closing set of books for the build — estimated against actual, category by category.

Purpose of Final Budget Reconciliation

This final accounting document provides a complete financial picture of your owner-builder project. Use it to:

- Document the total project cost for future reference
- Identify where you stayed on budget and where you went over
- Extract valuable lessons for future building projects
- Provide accurate cost data if you sell the property
- Support tax filings and potential deductions

WHEN TO COMPLETE: Fill in this reconciliation when all work is finished and all invoices have been paid.

PROJECT OVERVIEW

Project Address: _____

Project Start Date: _____ Project Completion Date: _____

Total Duration (months): _____ Square Footage Built: _____

FINAL BUDGET SUMMARY

Estimated vs. Actual by Category

Budget Category	Estimated Budget (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance +/- (\$)
Site Preparation			
Foundation			
Framing			
Roofing			
Exterior (Siding, Windows, Doors)			

Estimated vs. Actual by Category

Budget Category	Estimated Budget (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance +/- (\$)
Rough-In (Plumbing, Electrical, HVAC)			
Insulation			
Drywall			
Flooring			
Cabinets & Countertops			
Fixtures (Plumbing, Lighting, etc.)			
Paint & Finishes			
Permits & Fees			
Tools & Equipment			
Labor (Subcontractors)			
Contingency (Used/Unused)			
Other			
TOTAL PROJECT COST			

FINAL BUDGET ANALYSIS

Total Estimated Budget (\$): _____ Total Actual Cost (\$): _____

Total Variance +/- (\$): _____ Cost Per Square Foot (\$): _____

Percentage Variance (%) — circle one: over / under budget: _____

Biggest Cost Overruns (Top 5)

Rank	Category/Item	Amount Over Budget (\$)	Primary Reason
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			

Biggest Cost Savings (Top 5)

Rank	Category/Item	Amount Saved (\$)	How Savings Achieved
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			

LESSONS LEARNED FOR FUTURE PROJECTS**1. Budgeting**

2. Cost Control

3. Vendor/Subcontractor Selection

4. Areas to Allocate More Budget Next Time

5. Overall Financial Advice for Future Owner-Builders
